1) For my macOS Silicon chip it appears that the root document used was located at: /opt/homebrew/var/www. The directive that set it was: ‘root /opt/homebrew/var/www;’
2) It returns a 404 status (not found) with a simple body saying “Not Found”
3) The header, specifically the Host nginx reads the hostname and compares it with the servernames to make sure the proper one is loaded.
4) For alpha.test we have the proxy_pass directive forward to the backend A at http://127.0.0.1:3001, for beta.test we forward to http://127.0.0.1:3002
5) The browser TLS terminates at nginx which then handles the https using the configured certificates and keys
6) To prevent outside interference/tampering. If it were exposed then external clients could potentially bypass NGINX and the HTTPS encryption. In short, security.